



Data Breach at Olympics 2020

Details and passwords of ticketholders have been leaked, in a data breach at the Olympic games. <http://digit.in/aug21-31>



Shortage in Microsoft!!

Microsoft's ongoing component shortages will continue to impact Windows 6 it's other businesses <http://digit.in/aug21-32>

While this problem is not an overwhelmingly severe issue, what makes things go sideways is for example a navigation command that goes unnoticed by the system, and also by the user leading to them driving to the wrong place.

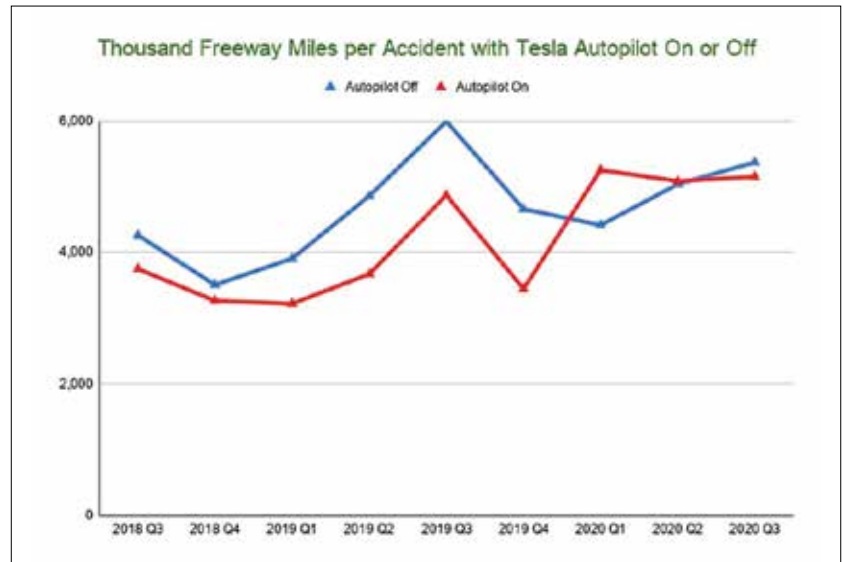
As per the user reports popping up, as recent as July this year, Google Assistant, when called out with the command 'navigate to', does not seem to understand and throws back a reply, 'not sure how to help with this'. You might say that well, why not key the command in using the giant touch screen which you use to play Fruit Ninja while stuck in traffic? That's a valid argument but isn't that what these 'smart' assistive features are supposed to do for us in the first place? What's even worse for Google and the end-users is that Google released a fix for this issue in the month of May itself. Yet, the user reports continue to flood in. So, in this case, what is a driver supposed to do? Stop the car and set things manually in spite of having paid a premium for this feature, or continue to try conveying what he or she wants to the Google Assistant, putting themselves at risk?

There are still a lot of useful features that are available in Android Auto, and they are indeed a great addition to the driving experience of users but given that this issue exists in one of the most fundamental functionalities of this tech is what drives this wave of concern.

It is not the voice commands and Android Auto only that have been flinging issues towards the users. Automated driving technology, too, in recent years has been causing problems, adding to the already existing problems that have come along with more and more tech being put into cars.

IT IS NOT REALLY AUTOPILOT

One of the most talked-about technological development that was rolled out in consumer-grade cars in the recent years, the Tesla autopilot



The numbers don't lie

Source: Forbes

has been touted to be the first true example of a self-driving car. At some point the marketing hype seems to have exaggerated what these vehicles are actually capable of, with even Tesla engineers admitting that they may not be able to roll out all the features that they have promised to consumers who have already picked up the vehicles.

What started off as a special additional package in Elon Musk's latest Tesla line of cars in October 2014 has almost become the industry benchmark when it comes to driving automation. If you just scratch the surface of the internet, you can find stories of how accidents are being caused day in and day out because people behind the wheel of a Tesla Autopilot enabled car let it do all the driving. Mostly this is because the people were not keeping their eyes on the road and not using the vehicles as directed. Called the 'Future of Driving' on the company's website, and with claims such as, "Tesla cars come standard with advanced hardware capable of providing Autopilot features, and full self-driving capabilities—through software updates designed to improve functionality over time." It is only as you get to the fine print that you come across it written clearly that it requires 'active

driver supervision'. The question is if the piecemeal automation improve driver safety at all?

As it was found out in a report published by Forbes earlier this year, Tesla Autopilot is just as safe as manually driving your car, unassisted, if not worse when it comes to safety.

These are just the first early steps into automation, and even if artificial intelligence can never lead us to fully self driving cars as some pessimistic technologists claim, having at least an extra pair of eyes on the road to provide alerts for possible collisions and overspeeding by drivers are potential ways of improving safety, keeping the driver in the loop.

CONNECTED CARS

In the near term, vehicles are expected to be able to avoid obstacles and predict collisions with other vehicles better, but not the accidents associated with reckless driving, or dangerous maneuvers on the road. The problem with automated driving systems is that for them to deliver on the safety promise, it is needed for other vehicles on the road to have machine drivers as well. If all the cars on a road or in a city can communicate with each other automatically, then that allows for improving the safety of everything on the road. **d**